



Volendam — 2028 Grand World Voyage

129 days · round-trip Fort Lauderdale · departs January 4, 2028

Ship: ms Volendam (Holland America Line) · **From/to:** Port Everglades, Fort Lauderdale · **Cabin:** _____

A condensed Voyage Pack from [In the Wake](#) — the essentials in four pages. The full pack covers the ship, all eight legs and 45 ports, the pre-cruise year, four-season packing, the whole budget, and the emergency framework in depth.

The voyage, leg by leg

Port order follows Holland America's published route map; **every date below is approximate until your cruise documents finalize it** — and world-cruise itineraries change en route. That's part of the deal.

Leg	~When	Route	Worth knowing
1	Jan	Caribbean & Brazil — San Juan · Barbados · Devil's Island (you land on Île Royale) · Belém · Recife · Rio (extended) · Montevideo · Buenos Aires (extended)	Settle in, don't sprint. First equator crossing. Fix any cold-kit gaps in Buenos Aires — it's the last big store before the ice.
2	Feb	Patagonia & Antarctica — Port Stanley · Ushuaia · 4-day Antarctic Experience (scenic, no landings) · Cape Horn · Punta Arenas · Glacier Alley & Chilean fjords · Puerto Montt · San Antonio (Santiago)	The summit of the trip. Full cold kit + hand warmers on deck; the Crow's Nest is the warm seat. Falklands penguin trips book out — decide early.
3	Feb–Mar	The long Pacific — Easter Island (tender, swell-dependent) · Pitcairn · Papeete (evening) · Moorea · Bora Bora	Hold Easter Island loosely — ships miss it some years; the moai are worth the gamble. The whole Pacific run stays south of the equator. Sun protection becomes a medical topic.
4	Mar	New Zealand — 8 days, 6 ports: Auckland (overnight) · Tauranga · New Plymouth · Wellington · Picton · Lyttelton	Densest port stretch of the voyage. One thing per port, not three. Biosecurity is serious: declare food, clean shoes.
5	Mar	Australia & Indonesia — Sydney (overnight) · Brisbane · Townsville · Cairns · Torres Strait · Darwin · Komodo · Bali	The Sydney sail-in is the canonical arrival. Reef operators in Cairns book early. Komodo is ranger-escorted only.
6	Apr	SE Asia & Indian Ocean — Singapore (overnight) · Phuket · Colombo (evening) · Malé · Port Louis · Réunion	The second equator crossing comes on the run up to Singapore, the third southbound to Mauritius. Hawker centers over hotel restaurants in Singapore; hottest sustained stretch of the voyage. Réunion's cirque viewpoints are the taxi-day to take.
7	Apr	Africa — Durban · Cape Town (65 hours) · Lüderitz (tender) · Walvis Bay · Null Island sail-past · Takoradi · Abidjan	Table Mountain on the first clear morning, not the "scheduled" one. Robben Island books weeks ahead. Null Island is the fourth and final equator crossing, exactly at 0°,0°. Kolmanskop's last guided tour is 11:00 and the site shuts at 13:00 at weekends — take the earliest tender. Cape Coast Castle is a full day from Takoradi (~81 km each way) and deserves its gravity; Fort San Sebastian at Shama, 20 km out, is part of the same World Heritage listing if the long run is too much.
8	Apr–May	Atlantic home — Praia · Mindelo · crossing · San Juan · Fort Lauderdale	The crossing is the decompression chamber. The journal you kept is about to be priceless.

The world-cruise packing rule: you're outfitting a small life, not packing a trip. ~10–12 days of clothes + the ship's laundry, one full Antarctic layering kit (thermal base, fleece mid, windproof waterproof shell, hand warmers), twice the sun protection you think, and two dressy outfits re-worn without apology.

Currency aboard: USD. **Crew Appreciation:** \$18/day per person (standard) / \$20 (suites) — \$2,322 / \$2,580 across 129 days; rates as of mid-2026, reconfirm at booking.

The pre-cruise year — compressed

12+ months out (the can't-rush items):

- **Passport valid into 2029** with plentiful blank pages. Renew now if in doubt — every visa keys off it.
- **Travel-medicine clinic, itinerary in hand** — yellow fever (with certificate) and malaria decisions for West Africa are clinical calls needing lead time.
- **Insurance with medical-evacuation cover** — and check the per-trip duration cap; many policies stop at 90 days, which quietly disqualifies them for a 129-day voyage.
- **Book the cabin you can live in.** Ocean View over Interior matters more on 129 days than on any week-long cruise.

9 months out: bills on autopay · mail forwarded · **prescription vacation-override** started with your insurer (130+ days of meds, original bottles, carry-on) · house watched weekly (check your homeowner policy's vacancy clause).

6 months out: final payment (Grand Voyage schedule differs — calendar it at booking) · life-list excursions that sell out (South Africa safari add-on, Robben Island, Cairns reef, Falklands penguins) · flights to Fort Lauderdale **arriving Jan 3 at the latest.**

Final month: pack early enough to discover what you don't own · do the handoff card with your at-home contact out loud · say goodbyes with slack — four months is long enough for life at home to move.

Budget snapshot (per person, double occupancy — mid-2026 figures, all approximate)

Line	Range
Fare at booking opening	Interior ~\$29,999 · Ocean View ~\$34,499 · Suite ~\$57,599
Crew Appreciation (129 days)	\$2,322 standard · \$2,580 suite
Shore excursions	\$2,000–6,000+ (the widest-variance line)
Bar / specialty / spa	\$1,000–4,000
Internet (voyage-length package)	\$500–1,500
Visas, vaccines, insurance	\$1,500–4,000+
Port cash & misc	\$1,500–3,000

All-in for two in an Ocean View: plan around **\$85,000–100,000 per couple** — roughly \$330–390 per person per day for housing, food, transport, and six continents. Ship excursions at the remote tender ports (where ship-waits-for-you is worth real money); independent in the easy card cities (NZ, Australia, Singapore, Cape Town).

The short list that matters

Two numbers, memorized by your at-home contact:

- **Holland America emergency lines:** +1 (800) 426-0327 (Pacific business hours) / +1 (800) 628-4771 (after hours & holidays; critical emergencies only: +1 (206) 626-7382) — they confirm you boarded and relay messages to the ship anywhere on earth.
- **U.S. State Department 24/7:** +1 (888) 407-4747 (from abroad: +1 (202) 501-4444) — routes to the right embassy for whichever of the 26 countries the ship is in. Enroll in **STEP** (step.state.gov) before sailing.

Silence math for a world cruise: the Antarctic days, the Pacific, and the Indian Ocean make **multi-day quiet completely normal**. Agree on the rhythm before sailing (“a message every port day; don’t worry between them”) and write it on the handoff card.

Tender ports (conditions decide): Devil’s Island (landing on Île Royale) · Port Stanley · Easter Island · Moorea · Bora Bora · Komodo · Malé · Lüderitz. Plan them as “if the sea allows” days; the docked cities carry the schedule.

On the ship: the Crow’s Nest (forward observation lounge) is the scenic-day seat · the wrap-around promenade mile is the voyage’s best free amenity · Pinnacle Grill and Canaletto are the specialty venues · the Lido Pool’s sliding roof covers every climate you’ll cross · dial 90 from any ship phone for Guest Services, 24/7.

Sea-day survival: the week-six wall is real and it passes · budget energy like money · **journal ten minutes a night from Day 1** — by Cape Town you will not remember Recife without it.

Fill in when documents arrive: cabin _____ · muster station _____ · dining time _____ · Wi-Fi package _____ · onboard account card _____

Need the at-home emergency handoff card? Separate one-page doc ships with this pack. The full Voyage Pack is the unabridged companion; the PWA companion app (volendam-world-2028) carries the live route, weather, and this card offline. Soli Deo Gloria.